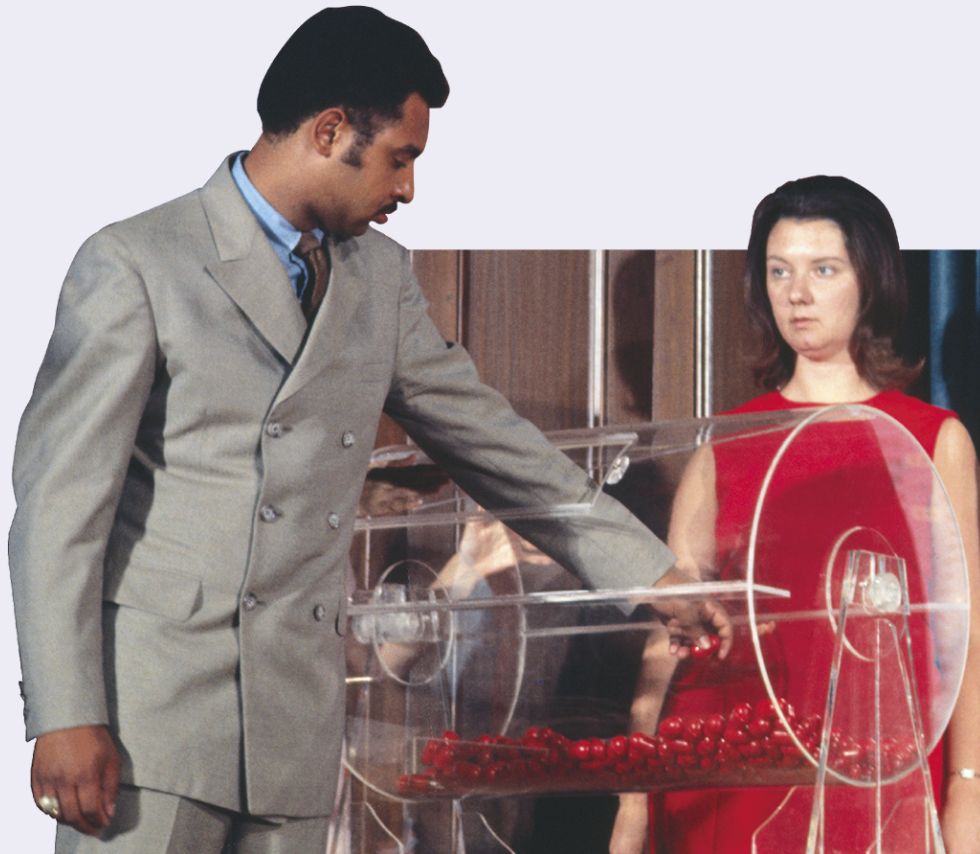


« BEFORE

The selective service system had long been a point of controversy. In December 1969, the US draft lottery began.

DRAFTEES TO VOLUNTEERS

Congress—concerned about requiring young Americans to participate in an increasingly unpopular war, and the fairness of the selection system—decided to draw birth dates by lottery to set the order of induction. However, the **continued unpopularity** of the draft led Congress to end the lottery in 1972 and institute an all-volunteer service.



THE NATIONAL DRAFT LOTTERY

In President Nixon's televised address on April 30, 1970, he declared that he had rejected all political considerations when deciding to move against the enemy sanctuaries in Cambodia. He said that his primary concern had been to save American lives. He also said that he sought to bridge the country's deep differences over the war.

Instead, Nixon ignited a political firestorm that would engulf his presidency. A siege mentality began to develop inside the White House as it assessed domestic politics. Many members of Congress who were already opposed to the war exploded in anger over Nixon's Cambodian incursion. Some charged that the administration had lied outright to Congress, as only days before the incursion Secretary of State William Rogers had testified to the Senate Foreign Relations Committee that there were no plans for operations in Cambodia. Nixon and Kissinger had not informed Rogers of the imminent attack.

Congressional doves

On May 1, two bills challenged the president's authority. Republican John Sherman Cooper of Kentucky and Democrat Frank Church of Idaho sponsored a measure to cut off all funds for military operations in Cambodia after June 30. Republican Senator Mark